This hands-on lab walks you through creating a Laravel 12 web application that validates form inputs with customized error messages and rules. You'll define your own validation rules and override default error messages to give users a more helpful and user-friendly experience.

7.7.2 Objectives

By completing this lab, you will learn how to:

- Use Laravel's validation system with custom rules
- Define and apply custom error messages
- Display those messages in the Blade view using Bootstrap
- Create a better user experience with clear, contextual validation feedback

7.7.3 Prerequisites

- PHP 8.1+ and Composer installed
- Laravel 12 installed
- Basic knowledge of Laravel routing, controllers, and Blade
- Visual Studio Code or any code editor
- Internet access to load Bootstrap via CDN

> *This lab uses **PHP 8.4**, **Laravel 12** and **Visual Studio Code** as the primary editor.*

7.7.4 Steps

Here's a step-by-step guide to creating a custom validation system:

7.7.4.1 Step 1: Create a New Laravel Project

First, create a new Laravel project using the Laravel installer. If you don't have it installed, you can use Composer to create a new project.

```
laravel new custom-validation
cd custom-validation
code .
```

You should see a new Laravel project set up. Now, let's create the necessary routes and views.